disobedience against the previous ruler, unemployment, and the low standard of living turned into terrorist activity that has claimed thousands of victims. Tunisia has witnessed the killing of foreigners and the destruction of its cultural assets, the political murder of opposition leaders, and the spread of riots across the country. The terrorist activities were attributed to jihadist elements, and in July 2013, for the first time, to al-Qaeda.

The 2011 elections, as well as those of 2014, were held in the shadow of ongoing terrorism and political instability. The secular ruling party led by President Essebsi and the second-largest party, the Islamic al-Nahda led by Rached Ghannouchi, adopted a pragmatic approach in an attempt to establish a coalition to address the issues currently facing the Tunisian public —namely, economic growth, development, unemployment, and working conditions. Will they succeed? This is a major question. President Essebsi is ninety-two years old. His party was established only a few years ago and is identified with President Bourguiba's authoritarian rule, and his potential partner Ghannouchi, founder and ideological leader of al-Nahda, as noted spent a generation in exile in England. These starting points do not seem to guarantee long-term success. It is a bit like mixing fire and water.

Let us remind ourselves that Tunisia's neighbor to the west, Algeria, had a similar experience in the early 1990s when the radical Muslim GIA Party took part in democratic elections. The party's leaders declared in the election campaign that they would participate in the democratic political game but that if and when they won they would declare a sharia state. GIA did indeed win the election, but at the last minute the military leaders decided to prevent it from taking power. From then until now, for more than twenty years, what is for all intents and purposes a civil war has been raging in Algeria between the military government and the Muslim underground.

And what happened in Egypt? In 2011, the internet brought millions of people to Tahrir Square. These masses, who persevered with their presence in the square for many days, were indeed a necessary condition for the overthrow of the regime, but they were not a sufficient one! President Obama provided the other necessary condition when he chose the will of the masses over what had been the United States' most important ally in the Middle East since the early 1970s. And what next?

The power of social networks lies in their ability to mobilize the masses and bring them out into the streets. The weakness of social networks is that at least to date they have not been able to produce leaders who know how to